

MOVIE

Enola Holmes

★★★★☆ | Netflix's *Enola Holmes* is not so much a detective film, as it is a story about a child that refuses to follow the rules but still ends up saving the day. A feminist look at the Sherlock Holmes tale, *Enola* tells the story of the titular Enola Holmes, sister to Sherlock and Mycroft Holmes. Raised by her mother in seclusion, she grows into a young woman with a 'different' outlook on life. Not the typical Victorian school-girl we've all come to know but more of a wild child with a curiosity for the unknown. One day, Enola's mother goes missing, leaving very obvious clues and it's up to the plucky youngster to find her.

The film is directed by Harry Bradbeer, who's worked on lacklustre



but critically acclaimed shows such as *Killing Eve* and *Fleabag* so in some way the film is written to tick off checkboxes that when examined a little closer threaten to pull the film down as a whole. Based on the book

of the same name, *Enola Holmes* stars Millie Bobby Brown (*Stranger Things*) as the titular character and a surprisingly dull Henry Cavill as Sherlock Holmes. The cast is rounded off by Helena Bonham Carter (*Fight Club*, *The Harry Potter* series) as Eudoria Holmes as well as Sam Claflin (*The Nightingale*) as Mycroft Holmes. The cast is no doubt impressive but with the material they're given, it's hard to fault them for their performances here. Millie Bobby Brown is the standout here, as it should be, and she is effervescent as Enola. Equally precocious and curious, she exudes film star magic and really lifts the film as a whole.

In conclusion, *Enola Holmes* will entertain young girls and maybe the odd adult but more often than not, if you peel away the thin layer of story, you'll find a film that is more concerned with checking the required boxes than actually telling an engaging and coherent story.

MOVIE

The Devil All The Time

★★★★☆ | Antonio Campos' inclination towards dealing with the fragile human psyche is nothing out of the ordinary. With his latest adaptation of Donald Ray Pollock's bestselling Southern Gothic novel, he takes it up a notch, by shining light on multiple sinister characters in a post-war backdrop.

The Devil All The Time is a convoluted tale where a handful of dreadful stories set in several instances of time come together eventually. Set in the 1960s, the plot is centred around Alvin Russell (Tom Holland), a troubled Christian orphan who plans on overcoming the evil forces that threaten him and his family. In the process, he encounters an unholy preacher, a psychopathic couple and a corrupt alcoholic sheriff, all hiding numerous dark secrets. The pacing of



this twisted, non-linear narrative is a bit slow. And for good reason. Campos' direction takes its time building the characters. It goes on to give a clear picture, as to how deranged or broken some of these "sinners" are. The emotions are fleshed out really well and their transitioning into the Devil incarnate just feels natural; and justified, in a sense. This would not be possible without

the ensemble cast who delivered an outstanding performance. With a cast as massive as this, there is bound to be some that stands out from the rest. In this case, it is Holland, Skarsgård and Pattinson, who graced us with their vengeful, troubled and seductive acts respectively. Adding on, a good majority of the cast is not of American origin. Yet, they all managed to hit the Southern accent quite convincingly, with added flair.

Cinematography-wise there are no complaints, as the film manages to capture the dark, violent and ominous setting seamlessly. Watching the film, you immediately realise, you have stepped into the wrong territory. The runtime, however, is lengthy – a whopping 138 minutes. Some of the subplots pertaining to minor characters could have easily been cut-down, or conveyed via narration during B-rolls. Surprisingly, the narrator for this film is the original author himself.

Overall, *The Devil All The Time* proves to be an amazingly bizarre and disturbing film, with an unhealthy obsession for blood, religion and chicken livers!